

SEE-THROUGH SOLID

MAKING GLASS

People have been making glass objects for at least 6,000 years. Sand is one of the main substances used to make glass. When melted and formed into a solid, glass has many useful properties—it is hard when cool but is easily shaped when heated, it doesn't react with many chemicals, and it is transparent. As a result, glass can be used to make a variety of objects, such as bottles and jars, laboratory equipment, car windshields, and even computer screens.

TRANSPARENCY

We see objects when light bounces or reflects off them into our eyes. Most glass is transparent, meaning visible light passes through and we can see things on the other side. Frosted glass is translucent, only allowing some light through. Opaque materials don't allow any light through.

